

FOST TRAINING RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FEB 17

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

PART 1

1. To which vessels do these rules apply? (R1.a) **(1)**

2. In construing and complying with these rules due regard shall be had to what? (R2.b) **(2)**

3. Can a vessel cross a narrow channel or fairway? (R9.d) **(2)**

4. A vessel other than a crossing vessel or a vessel joining or leaving a lane shall not normally enter a separation zone or cross a separation line except... (R10.e) **(2)**

5. What action should be taken by two power driven vessels approaching each other on reciprocal courses so as to involve risk of collision? (R14.a) **(2)**

6. If there is sufficient sea room what may be the most effective action to avoid a close quarters situation? (R8.c) **(2)**

7. Define the word 'underway' (R3.i) **(1)**

8. Define the term 'restricted visibility' (R3.l) **(1)**

9. What obligation does a vessel the passage of which is not to be impeded have when approaching another vessel so as to involve risk of collision? (R8.f) **(2)**

10. The Rules of Part A Section II apply when? (R11) **(1)**

11. In Restricted Visibility at what speed should a vessel proceed? (R19.b) **(2)**

12. To which Traffic Separation Schemes to the rule apply? Do they over-ride the other rules? (R10.a) **(2)**

13. When shall a vessel be deemed to be overtaking? (R13.b) **(2)**

14. Assumptions shall not be made on the basis of what? (R7.c) **(1)**

PART 2

You are the OOW in your Type 23 (over 50m in length). You have just slipped MSJ in Portsmouth and are proceeding outbound for the Dover Straits via the Solent. It is daylight and visibility is 10 Nautical Miles.

15. On channel 12 VHF you hear Southampton VTS talking to the Captain of a dredger working just south of Outer Spit Buoy.

a). What is this ship required to display to indicate her special condition by day? (R27) **(2)**

b). What lights would this vessel display if under way and making way at night, length 125 metres and has obstructions caused by her dredging equipment on her port side? (R27) **(2)**

16. As you pass clear of the Outer Spit Buoy the pilot is planning to disembark via launch. What lights would you expect the launch to display (<50m). (R29) **(1)**

17. As you pass St Helens Road Anchorage the CO observes a Ship approaching the anchorage and ask you what shapes a vessel at anchor should show by day (>100m). (R30) **(1)**

18. You safely pass the St Helens Anchorage and proceed outbound towards Nab Tower passing to the west of the tower. At Green 40, range 6 miles you sight a vessel displaying a black cylinder. What is this vessel? (R28) **(1)**

19. The compass bearing of the vessel is steady and you are 40 degrees on his port bow. What action is required by the Rules? (R15) **(1)**

20. You clear NAB Tower and continue to head South-East towards the Dover Straits Traffic Separation Scheme. You sight a number of small vessels exhibiting a shape consisting of two cones, apexes together, in a vertical line. What are these vessels? (R26) **(1)**

21. You approach the start of the traffic separation scheme (TSS). How should you navigate in this area? (R10.f) **(1)**

22. You continue to navigate through the TSS enjoying the pleasant weather. At Green 40, Range 6 miles you sight a cross channel ferry (power driven vessel). It's bearing is steady and it is crossing the TSS, you are on her Red 40.

a. Who is the give way vessel? (R10, R15).**(1)**

b. What would be your preferred action to avoid collision in this case when there are numerous vessels on your port and starboard sides? (R8.e) **(1)**

23. The ferry passes clear and you continue to proceed up the TSS. The MEO has asked for a full power trial and anticipates it will last 1 hour. Before you call the CO to request permission what are four of the considerations that must be taken in determining safe speed by all vessels? (R6.a) **(4)**

24. Having completed your full power trial you clear the TSS and head up the North Sea and in to open water. The visibility ahead starts to reduce. You call the CO and reduce speed. What sound signal should you start making and at what interval shall it not exceed? (R35.a) **(2)**

25. Apparently forward of the beam you hear the fog signal of another vessel consisting of one prolonged blast followed by two short blasts

a. Name two types of vessel this could this be? (R34.c) **(2)**

b. The vessel is not detected on radar nor can you see the vessel. What action should you take? (R19.e) **(2)**

26. Having conducted the actions required, at Green 30 you see a small fishing vessel (engaged in fishing not trawling, <50m) apparently stopped in the water.

a. What lights would you expect this vessel to show if it was not making way through the water? (R26) **(2)**

b. If risk of collision were to exist with this vessel forward of your beam who would be the give way vessel? (Visibility is still reduced in the vicinity although you are in sight of one another)? (R18) **(1)**

27. Fortunately visibility clears shortly after you encounter the fishing vessel. You continue to proceed north through the North Sea for your rendezvous with HMS BULWARK for some OOW manoeuvres and a PHOTEX which requires you to launch your helicopter. You sight BULWARK ahead and she is operating her LCVPs from her well dock. She is indicating Restricted in Ability to Manoeuvre, as are you. Who has right of way under ATP(1)G? **(1)**

28. The LCVPs working with BULWARK are less than 12 metres in length. What is the minimum visibility of their:

a. Masthead Light (R22) **(1)**

b. Sidelight (R22) **(1)**

PART 1 - Answers

1. To which vessels do these rules apply? (R1.a) (1)

These rules shall apply to all vessels upon the high seas and waters connected therewith navigable by seagoing vessels.

2. In construing and complying with these rules due regard shall be had to what? (R2.b) (2)

In construing and complying with these rules due regard shall be had to all dangers of navigation and collision and to any special circumstances, including the limitations of the vessels involved, which may make a departure from these rules necessary to avoid immediate danger.

3. Can a vessel cross a narrow channel or fairway? (R9.d) (2)

A vessel shall not cross a narrow channel or fairway if such crossing impedes the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within such channel or fairway. The latter vessel may use the sound signal prescribed in Rule 34(d) if in any doubt as to the intentions of the crossing vessel.

4. A vessel other than a crossing vessel or a vessel joining or leaving a lane shall not normally enter a separation zone or cross a separation line except... (R10.e) (2)

A vessel other than a crossing or a vessel joining or leaving a lane shall not normally enter a separation zone or cross a separation line except:

- (i) In cases of emergency to avoid immediate danger;**
- (ii) to engage in fishing within a separation zone.**

5. What action should be taken by two power driven vessels approaching each other on reciprocal courses so as to involve risk of collision? (R14.a) (2)

When two power driven vessels are meeting on reciprocal or nearly reciprocal courses so as to involve risk of collision each shall alter her course to starboard so that each shall pass on the port side of the other.

6. If there is sufficient sea room what may be the most effective action to avoid a close quarters situation? (R8.c) (2)

If there is sufficient sea room, alteration of course alone may be the most effective action to avoid a close quarters situation provided it is made in good time, is substantial and does not result in another close quarters situation.

7. Define the word 'underway' (R3.i) (1)

The word 'underway' means that a vessel is not at anchor, made fast to the shore, or aground.

8. Define the term 'restricted visibility' (R3.l) (1)

The term 'restricted visibility' means any condition in which visibility is restricted by fog, mist, falling snow, heavy rain-storms, sandstorms or any other similar causes.

9. What obligation does a vessel the passage of which is not to be impeded have when approaching another vessel so as to involve risk of collision? (R8.f) (2)

A vessel the passage of which is not to be impeded remains fully obliged to comply with the rules of this part when approaching another vessel so as to involve risk of collision.

10. The Rules of Part A Section II apply when? (R11) (1)

Rules in this section apply to vessels in sight of one another.

11. In Restricted Visibility at what speed should a vessel proceed? (R19.b) (2)

Every vessel shall proceed at a safe speed adapted to the prevailing circumstances and conditions of restricted visibility. A power driven vessel shall have her engines ready for immediate manoeuvre.

12. To which Traffic Separation Schemes to the rule apply? Do they over-ride the other rules? (R10.a) (2)

This rule applies to Traffic Separation Schemes adopted by the Organisation and does not relieve a vessel of her obligation under any other rule.

13. When shall a vessel be deemed to be overtaking? (R13.b) (2)

A vessel shall be deemed to be overtaking when coming up with another vessel from a direction more than 22.5 degrees abaft her beam, that is, in such a position with reference to the vessel she is overtaking that at night she would be able to see only the sternlight of that vessel but neither sidelights.

14. Assumptions shall not be made on the basis of what? (R7.c) (1)

Assumptions shall not be made on the basis of scanty information, especially scanty radar information.

Part 1 ____ /25

PART 2 - Answers

You are the OOW in your Type 23 (over 50m in length). You have just slipped MSJ in Portsmouth and are proceeding outbound for the Dover Straits via the Solent. It is daylight and visibility is 10 Nautical Miles.

15. On channel 12 VHF you hear Southampton VTS talking to the Captain of a dredger working just south of Outer Spit Buoy.

a). What is this ship required to display to indicate her special condition by day? (R27) (2)

Three shapes in a vertical line where they can best be seen. The highest and lowest of these shapes shall be balls and the middle a diamond.

b). What lights would this vessel display if under way and making way at night, length 125 metres and obstructions caused by her dredging equipment on her port side? (R27) (2)

Masthead Light (x2), Sidelights, stern light, 3 all round lights in a vertical line the upper and lower being red and the middle white. On the foul side two all round red lights in a vertical line and the clear side two all round green lights in a vertical line.

16. As you pass clear of the Outer Spit Buoy the pilot is planning to disembark via launch. What lights would you expect the launch to display (<50m). (R29) (1)

At or near the masthead two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being white and the lower red. Sidelights, stern light.

17. As you pass St Helens Road Anchorage the CO observes a ship approaching the anchorage and ask you what shapes a vessel at anchor should show by day (>100m). (R30) (1)

In the forepart one ball

18. You safely pass the St Helens Anchorage and proceed outbound towards Nab Tower passing to the west of the tower. At Green 40, range 6 miles you sight a vessel displaying a black cylinder. What is this vessel? (R28) (1)

Vessel Constrained by her Draught

19. The compass bearing of the vessel is steady and you are 40 degrees on his port bow. What action is required by the Rules? (R15) (1)

When two power driven vessels are crossing so as to involve risk of collision, the vessel which has the other on her own starboard side shall keep out of the way of the other

The fact that the other vessel involved is a CBD does not impact on this situation when risk of collision is deemed to exist between two PDV's.

20. You clear NAB Tower and continue to head South-East towards the Dover Straits Traffic Separation Scheme. You sight a number of small vessels exhibiting a shape consisting of two cones, apexes together, in a vertical line. What are these vessels? (R26) (1)

Vessels engaged in fishing

21. You approach the start of the traffic separation scheme (TSS). How should you navigate in this area? (R10.f) (1)

A vessel navigating in area near the termination of the lane shall do so with particular caution.

22. You continue to navigate through the TSS enjoying the pleasant weather. At Green 40, Range 6 miles you sight a cross channel ferry (power driven vessel). Its bearing is steady and it is crossing the TSS, you are on her Red 40.

a. Who is the give way vessel? (R10, R15). **(1)**

Own vessel is the give way vessel in accordance with Rule 15. Rule 10 does not relieve a vessel of her obligation under any other rule.

b. What would be your preferred action to avoid collision in this case when there are numerous vessels on your port and starboard sides? (R8.e) **(1)**

If necessary to avoid collision or allow more time to assess the situation, a vessel shall slacken her speed or take all way off by stopping or reversing her means of propulsion.

In this case an adjustment of speed may be the most suitable action to avoid a collision given the constraints imposed by other traffic.

23. The ferry passes clear and you continue to proceed up the TSS. The MEO has asked for a full power trial and anticipates it will last 1 hour. Before you call the CO to request permission what are four of the considerations that must be taken in determining safe speed by all vessels? (R6.a) **(4)**

(i) State of Visibility

(ii) Traffic Density including concentrations of fishing vessels or any other vessels.

(iii) The manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions.

(iv) At night the presence of background lights such as from shore lights or from the back scatter of her own lights

(v) The state of wind, sea and current, and the proximity of navigational hazards.

(vi) The draught in relation to the available depth and width of navigable water.

24. Having completed your full power trial you clear the TSS and head up the North Sea and in to open water. The visibility ahead starts to reduce. You call the CO and reduce speed. What sound signal should you start making and at what interval shall it not exceed? (R35.a) **(2)**

A power driven vessel making way through the water shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes one prolonged blast.

25. Apparently forward of the beam you hear the fog signal of another vessel consisting of one prolonged blast followed by two short blasts

a. Name two types of vessel this could this be? (R34.c) **(2)**

A vessel not under command, a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, a vessel constrained by her draught, a sailing vessel, a vessel engaged in fishing and a vessel engaged in towing or pushing.

b. The vessel is not detected on radar nor can you see the vessel. What action should you take? (R19.e) **(2)**

shall reduce her speed to the minimum at which she can be kept on course. She shall if necessary take all way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until risk of collision is over.

26. Having conducted the actions required, at Green 30 you see a small fishing vessel (engaged in fishing not trawling, <50m) apparently stopped in the water.

a. What lights would you expect this vessel to show if it was not making way through the water? (R26) **(2)**

Two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and the lower white.

b. If risk of collision were to exist with this vessel forward of your beam who would be the give way vessel? (Visibility is still reduced in the vicinity although you are in sight of one another)? (R18) **(1)**

IAW Rule 18 (Responsibilities between Vessels) Own vessel would be the Give Way. Rule 19 only applies to vessels not in sight of one another when navigating in or near an area of restricted visibility.

27. Fortunately visibility clears shortly after you encounter the fishing vessel. You continue to proceed north through the North Sea for your rendezvous with HMS BULWARK for some OOW manoeuvres and a PHOTEX which requires you to launch your helicopter. You sight BULWARK ahead and she is operating her LCVPs from her well dock. She is indicating Restricted in Ability to Manoeuvre, as are you. Who has right of way under ATP(1)G? **(1)**

Launching or recovering landing craft has higher precedence than launching or recovering aircraft therefore BULWARK has right of way.

28. The LCVPs working with BULWARK are less than 12 metres in length. What is the minimum visibility of their:

a. Masthead Light (R22) **(1)**

2 nautical miles

b. Sidelight (R22) **(1)**

1 nautical mile